

Overall Validation Determination Module (OVDM)

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Governed Space

Overall Validation Determination

Canonical Definition

Overall Validation Determination Module (OVDM) defines the governance framework for transforming the complete governed Validation Determination Basis, criterion-level determinations, conflict and uncertainty conditions, cross-criterion integration structure, scope boundaries, Validation Depth, methodological limitations, and determination constraints into a formal, bounded, traceable, and methodologically defensible Overall Validation Determination.

It establishes the final conclusion stage of the Validation Determination Standard and determines what the complete governed validation event legitimately demonstrates about the Validation Object.

Operational Role

OVDM serves as the fifth and final internal governance space of the Validation Determination Standard.

The preceding modules establish:

VDBRQM — Which results may legitimately participate in determination?

VCDM — What does the qualified result set demonstrate about each Validation Criterion?

VDCUGM — Which conflicts, uncertainties, and Determination Constraints remain?

VCCIM — How should criterion outcomes be integrated according to their governance significance and relationships?

OVDM asks:

What Overall Validation Determination does the complete governed validation record legitimately support?

The governed progression is:

Qualified Determination Basis → Criterion Determinations → Conflict & Uncertainty Conditions → Cross-Criterion Integration Structure → Overall Determination Assessment → Determination Classification → Formal Validation Determination Record

OVDM closes Validation Determination.

It does not assign the persistent Validation State of the Validation Object.

Module Operational Space

OVDM governs:

- Overall Validation Determination,
- determination classification,
- positive determination,
- conditional determination,
- negative determination,
- indeterminate determination,
- partial determination,
- hierarchical determination,
- determination scope,
- determination depth,
- determination conditions,
- determination restrictions,
- determination limitations,
- determination uncertainty,
- determination conflict effects,
- determination authority,
- determination rationale,
- determination transparency,
- determination traceability,
- determination effective point,
- determination versioning,

- determination change,
- determination correction,
- determination reassessment,
- determination suspension,
- determination withdrawal,
- determination supersession,
- determination continuity,
- and transition to Validation State governance.

Module Function

OVDM applies after the cross-criterion determination structure has been sufficiently established.

Its function is to prevent:

- criterion outcomes remaining unintegrated while a global validation claim is issued,
- positive determination being inferred from majority satisfaction alone,
- critical failures being diluted,
- Not Determinable criteria being treated as neutral where they are materially significant,
- unresolved conflict being erased at conclusion,
- uncertainty disappearing,
- conditional findings becoming unconditional,
- partial validation becoming universal validation,
- executed scope being expanded during reporting,
- Validation Depth being overstated,
- determination authority remaining unclear,
- and a phrase such as “validated” being issued without a reconstructable methodological meaning.

Overall Validation Determination

An **Overall Validation Determination** is the formal conclusion supported by the complete governed validation event.

It describes what the validation record legitimately demonstrates about the Validation Object within:

- the validated object version,
- Validation Purpose,
- actual Validation Scope,
- achieved Validation Depth,
- applicable Validation Criteria,
- approved methodological structure,
- evidence conditions,
- source conditions,
- execution conditions,
- conflict state,
- uncertainty state,
- and applicable limitations.

It is a bounded methodological conclusion.

Determination Is an Event-Level Conclusion

OVDM governs the conclusion produced by a particular governed validation event.

This is important because the same Validation Object may later undergo:

- modification,
- new validation,
- revalidation,
- expanded validation,
- reduced-scope validation,
- or validation under different conditions.

The Overall Validation Determination therefore remains linked to the validation event that produced it.

Determination Classification

OVDM may establish the following canonical Overall Validation Determination classes:

Positive Validation Determination

The complete governed validation record sufficiently demonstrates satisfaction of the criteria required for a positive conclusion within the defined scope, depth, and conditions.

Conditional Validation Determination

The validation record supports a positive conclusion only under explicit conditions, restrictions, limitations, assumptions, reduced scope, or other governed boundaries.

Negative Validation Determination

The validation record sufficiently demonstrates non-satisfaction of one or more criteria whose governance significance prevents a positive conclusion for the defined determination scope.

Indeterminate Validation Determination

The governed validation record does not provide sufficient legitimate basis to establish either a positive or negative overall conclusion.

Partial Validation Determination

Distinct parts of the Validation Object, Validation Scope, criterion structure, population, environment, or operational domain

legitimately support different determination outcomes.

These classes must remain distinct.

Positive Validation Determination

A Positive Validation Determination requires more than many favorable results.

OVDM asks whether the complete integration structure permits a positive outcome.

This may require:

- all mandatory criteria satisfied,
 - no disqualifying critical failures,
 - required prerequisites satisfied,
 - no exclusionary conditions triggered,
 - required Determination Constraints resolved,
 - uncertainty remaining within acceptable bounds,
 - and sufficient scope and depth for the intended positive conclusion.
-

Positive Does Not Mean Universal

VALIDOS® establishes:

Positive Validation Determination ≠ Universal Validity

A positive determination may apply only to:

- a specific version,
- specific population,
- specific environment,
- specific configuration,
- specific operational state,
- specific jurisdiction,
- specific time,
- or another bounded condition.

The determination must preserve those boundaries.

Conditional Validation Determination

A Conditional Validation Determination is not a weaker wording for a Positive Determination.

It is a distinct governed conclusion.

The object is positively determined only if the relevant conditions remain satisfied.

Conditions may include:

- continued control,
- specific operating environment,
- restricted scope,
- specific configuration,
- limited population,
- monitoring requirement,
- corroboration requirement,
- specific evidence condition,
- limited duration,
- or another methodological restriction.

Conditionality Must Be Operationally Meaningful

A condition should be sufficiently precise to allow later governance to determine whether it remains satisfied.

Statements such as:

“Valid if used appropriately”

are too vague unless “appropriately” is governed elsewhere.

Conditions should be operationally referenceable where possible.

Negative Validation Determination

A Negative Validation Determination exists where the governed record sufficiently demonstrates that the requirements for a positive determination are not met because of actual non-satisfaction of one or more materially significant criteria.

Negative determination must remain grounded in positive evidence of non-satisfaction.

It should not be produced merely because:

- validation was incomplete,
- evidence was missing,
- uncertainty was high,
- or execution failed.

Those conditions may produce indeterminacy instead.

Indeterminate Validation Determination

An Indeterminate Validation Determination is appropriate where the governed validation process cannot legitimately establish either

positive or negative determination.

Possible causes include:

- mandatory criterion Not Determinable,
- unresolved critical conflict,
- determination-blocking uncertainty,
- insufficient determinant results,
- incompatible scopes,
- unresolved cross-criterion integration conflict,
- or another methodological limitation.

VALIDOS® establishes:

Indeterminate is an outcome, not an omission.

Partial Validation Determination

Partial Determination preserves structural truth where one global outcome would be misleading.

For example:

- Subsystem A: Positive
- Subsystem B: Conditional
- Subsystem C: Negative
- Subsystem D: Indeterminate

or:

- Adult Population: Positive
- Pediatric Population: Indeterminate

or:

- Normal Operation: Positive
- Degraded Operation: Negative

OVDM may represent these outcomes within one structured determination rather than forcing one universal label.

Hierarchical Validation Determination

For complex Validation Objects, OVDM may produce a hierarchical conclusion structure.

For example:

Criterion Determinations



Capability Determinations



Subsystem Determinations



Domain Determinations



Overall Validation Determination

Each higher-level conclusion should remain traceable to the lower-level determinations supporting it.

Overall Determination Scope

OVDM establishes the exact scope to which the Overall Validation Determination applies.

The determination scope must not exceed:

- legitimately executed scope,
- supported criterion scope,
- applicable evidence scope,
- reliable source scope,
- applicable object version,
- and conditions surviving cross-criterion integration.

Scope Intersection

Where required criteria support different scopes, the permissible overall positive scope may be constrained to the common supported region.

Conceptually:

Positive Determination Scope $\leq$ Common Supported Scope of Required Criteria

Where no coherent common scope exists, Partial Determination may be required.

Scope Exclusion

Specific areas may need explicit exclusion.

For example:

Positive Validation Determination excluding high-altitude operation.

Positive Validation Determination excluding pediatric use.

Conditional Validation Determination excluding autonomous operation without human supervision.

Exclusions should remain part of the determination record.

Determination Depth

The determination should preserve the Validation Depth actually achieved.

Possible architecture implementations may distinguish:

- preliminary validation,
- standard validation,
- enhanced validation,
- high-assurance validation,
- or other governed depth levels.

The determination must not imply a deeper assurance level than the validation performed.

Determination Strength Is Not Determination Type

A Positive Validation Determination may be supported at different strengths or depths.

Therefore:

Positive at Preliminary Depth

is not methodologically equivalent to:

Positive at High-Assurance Depth

OVDM preserves this distinction.

Determination Conditions

OVDM collects and consolidates material conditions propagated from:

- criterion determinations,
 - Evidence Fitness,
 - Source Reliability,
-

- Execution Conformity,
- conflict governance,
- uncertainty governance,
- cross-criterion integration,
- and scope constraints.

Conditions should not disappear merely because an overall conclusion has been reached.

Determination Restrictions

Restrictions may specify what the determination must not be used to imply.

Examples include:

- not applicable outside tested environment,
- not valid for another system version,
- not sufficient for regulatory approval,
- not sufficient for autonomous deployment,
- not valid after specified modification,
- or not transferable to another population.

Restrictions help prevent conclusion overreach.

Determination Limitations

Limitations describe known weaknesses or boundaries of the validation conclusion.

These may include:

- limited long-term evidence,
- limited rare-event coverage,
- incomplete external validation,
- constrained population representation,
- limited operational duration,
- unresolved low-frequency uncertainty,
- or other known limitations.

A positive determination may coexist with limitations.

Determination Uncertainty

OVDM preserves residual uncertainty remaining after VDCUGM and VCCIM.

The final determination should therefore be uncertainty-aware.

Where appropriate, uncertainty may be represented as:

- acceptable,
- conditionally acceptable,
- material but bounded,
- determination-limiting,
- or determination-blocking.

Determination Conflict Effects

A conflict may remain unresolved without completely preventing determination.

For example:

The conflict may be localized to one subsystem outside the positive determination scope.

OVDM therefore considers the actual effect of remaining conflict.

Determination Constraint Compliance

Before issuing the Overall Validation Determination, OVDM verifies whether applicable Determination Constraints produced earlier have been respected.

Examples include:

- required reduced scope,
- prohibition on unconditional positive determination,
- additional validation requirement,
- no aggregation across defined criteria,
- or mandatory Partial Determination.

Overall Determination Logic

OVDM should preserve the logic connecting:

Criterion Outcomes → Integration Rules → Constraints → Overall Determination

This logic must remain reconstructable.

A global conclusion should not appear as an unexplained final label.

Determination Rationale

A Validation Determination should include or reference sufficient rationale to explain:

- why the conclusion was selected,
- which criteria controlled it,
- which conflicts affected it,
- which uncertainty remained,
- which conditions apply,
- and why alternative determination classes were not selected where material.

Determination Authority

Where a formal determination requires identifiable authority, OVDM may govern:

- determination issuer,
- approval authority,
- delegated authority,
- decision system,
- required independence,
- required competence,
- authority scope,
- and authorization conditions.

OVDM does not create legal authority externally.

It governs the authority used within the methodology.

Single Determination Authority

One authorized evaluator or system may issue the final determination.

Where this occurs, the determination must still remain traceable to the governed validation record rather than personal preference.

Multi-Party Determination

Some validation environments may require multiple parties.

Possible structures include:

- validator + reviewer,
- technical evaluator + governance authority,
- automated determination + human approval,
- independent assessor + regulator,
- or other governed arrangements.

Determination Disagreement

Where authorized determination actors disagree, OVDM does not automatically use majority vote unless the governance structure explicitly defines that mechanism.

Disagreement may require:

- escalation,
- additional review,
- preserved dissent,
- or Indeterminate Determination.

Human Overall Determination

Human determination may be appropriate where integration involves substantial context, uncertainty, or judgment.

The governing requirement is that the human conclusion remains constrained by:

- criteria,
- results,
- integration rules,
- conflict conditions,
- uncertainty,
- scope,
- and methodological record.

Automated Overall Determination

Where determination logic is sufficiently explicit, OVDM may be automated.

Automated rules may implement:

- mandatory-criteria logic,
- critical-condition logic,
- hierarchical integration,
- exclusion rules,
- threshold structures,
- conditionality,
- and Determination Constraints.

The rule set should remain versioned and auditable.

AI-Assisted Overall Determination

AI may assist with:

- synthesis,
- rationale preparation,
- traceability reconstruction,
- condition extraction,
- inconsistency detection,
- scope checking,
- or explanation generation.

However:

AI Assistance ≠ Authority to Invent Determination Logic

The final determination must remain grounded in governed rules and records.

Determination Effective Point

The Overall Validation Determination should have an identifiable effective point.

This may include:

- issuance date,
- approval date,
- validation completion date,
- or another governed reference.

This is important because the next Parent Standard must determine the Validation State of the object over time.

Determination Is Not Necessarily Permanent

A determination reflects a governed conclusion at a specific point based upon a specific Validation Object and validation basis.

It may later change because of:

- new evidence,
 - source reassessment,
 - execution correction,
 - object modification,
 - method error,
 - discovered conflict,
 - or revalidation.
-

Validation Determination Record

A formal Overall Validation Determination Record should preserve, where applicable:

- Validation Determination Identifier,
- Validation Object,
- object version,
- Validation Purpose,
- determination scope,
- achieved Validation Depth,
- Validation Criteria,
- criterion-level determinations,
- cross-criterion integration structure,
- mandatory criteria status,
- critical criteria status,
- conflicts,
- uncertainty,
- Determination Constraints,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- limitations,
- Overall Validation Determination,
- determination rationale,
- determination authority,
- effective point,
- basis version,
- and sufficient lifecycle traceability.

Determination Statement

A formal determination statement should be capable of communicating more than:

“Validated.”

A governed statement should conceptually communicate:

What object

what version

for what purpose

within what scope

at what depth

against what criteria

with what outcome

subject to what conditions

with what limitations

at what effective point

This creates validation meaning.

Determination Traceability

OVDM preserves the complete determination chain:

Validation Object

↓

Validation Purpose & Scope

↓

Validation Criteria ↓

Validation Method

↓

Validation Evidence Fitness

↓

Validation Source Reliability

↓

Validation Execution

↓

Qualified Results

↓

Criterion Determinations

↓

Conflict & Uncertainty Governance

↓

Cross-Criterion Integration

↓

Overall Validation Determination

This becomes the primary conclusion lineage of VALIDOS®.

Determination Transparency

A qualified reviewer should be able to understand the methodological basis of the Overall Validation Determination.

Transparency may include:

- criteria outcome map,
- integration logic,
- conditions,
- limitations,
- conflict status,
- uncertainty status,
- and determination rationale.

Transparency does not require publication of confidential technical information beyond applicable governance obligations.

Determination Versioning

Materially revised determinations should remain distinguishable.

Possible representations may include:

Determination 1.0

Determination 1.1

Determination 2.0 The exact implementation can vary.

Historical determination states must remain available.

Determination Correction

A correction applies where the original determination contained an error but the underlying validation event can still support a corrected determination.

The record should preserve:

**Original Determination → Error → Correction →
Corrected Determination**

Determination Reassessment

Reassessment may occur when new information materially affects the original conclusion.

Possible triggers include:

- corrected result,
- newly identified execution deviation,
- evidence reassessment,
- Source Reliability reassessment,
- conflict resolution,
- new uncertainty,
- or methodological correction.

Determination Change

Possible determination transitions may include:

Positive → Conditional

Positive → Negative

Positive → Indeterminate

Conditional → Positive

Conditional → Negative

Negative → Positive

Indeterminate → Positive

or other governed transitions.

Change does not erase historical conclusions.

Determination Suspension

A determination may be suspended where serious new information creates material doubt before reassessment is complete.

Suspension means the determination should not continue to be represented as an unrestricted current conclusion.

Determination Withdrawal

A determination may be withdrawn where its methodological foundation is materially destroyed.

Possible causes include:

- wrong Validation Object,
- invalid critical execution,
- compromised decisive evidence,

- fundamental source unreliability,
- incorrect criterion architecture,
- or determination fraud.

Determination Supersession

A later governed validation event may produce a new determination superseding an earlier one.

The relationship should be explicit:

Determination A → Superseded by Determination B

Supersession does not delete Determination A.

Determination Continuity

OVDM preserves determination history across:

- object versions,
- revalidation,
- corrections,
- updates,
- scope changes,
- and lifecycle transitions.

This enables the next VALIDOS® Parent Standard to reason about the current Validation State rather than relying on one isolated conclusion.

Determination vs Validation State

This boundary is fundamental.

OVDM answers:

What did this validation event demonstrate?

The next Parent Standard must answer:

Given the relevant determinations and current lifecycle conditions, what Validation State does the object now hold?

Therefore:

Overall Validation Determination ≠ Validation State

Determination vs Reliance

OVDM also does not authorize reliance.

A Positive Validation Determination may exist while:

- deployment is prohibited,
- usage is restricted,
- regulatory approval is absent,
- revalidation is due,
- or the determination is unsuitable for a specific relying party.

Therefore:

Positive Validation Determination ≠ Reliance Authorization

Determination Handoff to Validation State

OVDM closes the eighth Parent Standard by handing forward:

- Overall Validation Determination,
- scope,
- depth,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- limitations,
- uncertainty,
- conflicts,
- effective point,
- determination version,
- and determination continuity references.

The next VALIDOS® Parent Standard can then determine how these elements become a formal Validation State.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Verify Cross-Criterion Integration

Confirm that the criterion integration structure is sufficiently complete and consistent.

2. Identify Controlling Criterion Conditions

Identify:

- mandatory criteria,
- critical criteria,
- exclusion conditions,
- unresolved Not Determinable criteria,
- and other controlling factors.

3. Verify Determination Constraints

Ensure all material conflict, uncertainty, and integration constraints have been respected.

4. Establish Permissible Determination Scope

Define the maximum scope legitimately supported by the validation record.

5. Establish Determination Depth

Preserve the Validation Depth actually achieved.

6. Consolidate Conditions, Restrictions, and Limitations

Carry forward all material boundaries from the complete VALIDOS® validation record.

7. Establish Overall Validation Determination Classify the result as:

- Positive Validation Determination,
- Conditional Validation Determination,
- Negative Validation Determination,
- Indeterminate Validation Determination,
- or Partial Validation Determination.

8. Establish Determination Rationale & Authority

Preserve why the conclusion was reached and by whom or what it was formally issued where applicable.

9. Establish Effective Point

Record when the determination becomes methodologically effective.

10. Create Overall Validation Determination Record

Preserve the complete conclusion basis.

11. Preserve Change & Continuity Governance

Maintain:

- corrections,
- reassessments,
- suspensions,
- withdrawals,
- supersession,
- versions,
- and historical continuity.

Governance Outputs

OVDM may produce:

- Overall Validation Determination,
- Positive Validation Determination Record,
- Conditional Validation Determination Record,
- Negative Validation Determination Record,
- Indeterminate Validation Determination Record,
- Partial Validation Determination Record,
- Hierarchical Validation Determination,
- Determination Scope Record,
- Determination Depth Record,
- Determination Condition Register,
- Determination Restriction Record,
- Determination Limitation Record,
- Determination Uncertainty Record,
- Determination Conflict Effect Record,
- Determination Constraint Compliance Record,
- Overall Determination Logic Record,
- Validation Determination Rationale,
- Validation Determination Authority Record,
- Validation Determination Effective Point,
- Overall Validation Determination Record,
- Validation Determination Traceability Map,
- Determination Transparency Record,
- Validation Determination Version,
- Determination Correction Record,
- Determination Reassessment Record,
- Determination Suspension Record,
- Determination Withdrawal Record,
- Determination Supersession Record,
- and Determination Continuity Reference.

Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI System

Scenario

An autonomous AI system satisfies all mandatory performance criteria.

One critical safety criterion is Conditionally Satisfied only where human override remains continuously available.

Application

VCCIM propagates the safety condition into the integrated criterion structure.

OVDM cannot issue an unrestricted Positive Validation Determination.

Result

The system receives:

Conditional Validation Determination

limited to operation under continuous human override availability.

The condition becomes part of the formal determination rather than an informal footnote.

Use Case 2 — Healthcare AI

Scenario

A diagnostic AI system is positively determined across the adult validation population.

Pediatric validation remains Not Determinable because the evidence basis is insufficient.

Application

OVDm limits the determination scope to the validated adult population.

Result

The system may receive:

Positive Validation Determination — Adult Population

together with an explicit exclusion of pediatric use from the positive determination scope.

It is not represented as universally validated.

Use Case 3 — Industrial Autonomous System

Scenario

An industrial system satisfies all normal-operation criteria but fails one critical recovery criterion during degraded operation.

Application

The cross-criterion integration structure identifies the recovery criterion as non-compensatory and critical.

Result

OVDm may establish:

Negative Validation Determination for the intended unrestricted operational scope

while preserving any separately valid positive determination for a narrower operational mode if that scope can be methodologically isolated.

Architectural Position

Overall Validation Determination is the fifth and final internal governance space of the **Validation Determination Standard (VDTs)**.

The complete VDTs progression is:

Validation Determination Basis & Result Qualification → Validation Criterion Determination → Validation Determination Conflict & Uncertainty Governance → Validation Cross-Criterion Integration → Overall Validation Determination

Together, these five governed spaces transform validation execution results into a formal and bounded validation conclusion.

The progression is:

Execution Outputs

↓

Qualified Determination Basis

↓

Criterion Determinations

↓

Governed Conflict & Uncertainty

↓

Cross-Criterion Integration

↓

Overall Validation Determination

The next VALIDOS® governance question becomes fundamentally different:

What formal Validation State should the Validation Object now hold as a result of the applicable determination and current lifecycle conditions?

Foundational Principle

A Validation Determination is legitimate only when its scope, strength, conditions, and conclusion do not exceed what the complete governed validation record is capable of demonstrating.

Canonical Closing Statement

Overall Validation Determination Module completes the formal conclusion lifecycle of the Validation Determination Standard within VALIDOS® by transforming qualified results, criterion-level determinations, conflicts, uncertainty, integration logic, scope, Validation Depth, conditions, restrictions, limitations, and Determination Constraints into a formal Overall Validation Determination. OVDM ensures that validation conclusions remain explicit, bounded, traceable, versioned, revisable, and methodologically defensible while preserving the critical architectural separation between what a validation event demonstrates, what Validation State an object subsequently holds, and whether any person, system, or organization may ultimately rely upon that state.

Parent Resources

[→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Internal Module Flow

[→ Previous module: Validation Cross-Criterion Integration Module \(VCCIM\)](#)

Related Documents

[→ Validation Determination Standard](#)

[→ About Validation Determination Standard](#)

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Canonical Source

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